

RADISHES *Raphanus sativus*

You may be surprised to discover that there are hundreds of different types of radish, not just the familiar small, red salad type. If you want some variety, try the large, white Oriental mooli (or daikon) radishes that can grow as long as 24 in (60 cm) and weigh up to 4.5 lb (2 kg), or grow winter radishes in rainbow shades of black, purple, yellow, or green, and eat these raw, or cook in the same way as rutabagas or turnips.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Radishes are a versatile crop and will grow in almost any location—they will tolerate partial shade, and are happy interplanted with other crops or grown in containers—but they dislike soil that has been recently manured. Radishes can be grown strategically to provide a year-round crop; very early radishes can be sown indoors before planting out; summer radishes should be sown directly in the ground in early spring; and winter radishes in mid- to late summer. By sowing a few seeds every few weeks you can achieve a continuous harvest.

Sow at a depth of .5 in (1 cm) in rows or blocks, thinning summer radishes to 1 in (2.5 cm) apart, and



Interplant with slow-growing crops.

winter radishes to 6 in (15 cm) apart once crops are established.

CROP CARE

Water regularly, but be careful not to overwater or you will simply encourage too much leafy growth.

HARVESTING

Summer radishes grow very quickly and some may be ready to eat in as little as one month.